

Commodities Sentiment Report

2026-07-08 09:35 UTC

Previous edition: 2026-07-07 20:05 UTC. Morning edition: overnight and Asian sessions digested the Iranian tanker attack; FOMC minutes land today at 2pm ET.

COMMODITY	SENTIMENT	CROWD	Δ VS LAST	ONE-LINE DRIVER
Crude Oil (WTI/Brent)	0 Neutral / mixed	●○○ 1	unchanged	API reportedly shows large draws; war premium holds WTI ~\$70 into today's EIA
Natural Gas	-1 Leaning bearish	○○○ 0	▲ from Bearish	Iran hit an LNG tanker — global gas up; late-July heat back in US forecasts
Gold	+1 Leaning bullish	●●○ 2	unchanged	Eased to ~\$4,141 pre-minutes; minutes predate the weak NFP, blunting their bite
Silver	+1 Leaning bullish	●●○ 2	unchanged	Third soft session, dipped under \$60 before recovering — underperforming gold
Copper	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Narrow range ~\$6.21; structural deficit story intact into Friday's COT
Wheat	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Chicago +2¢ / KC -¾¢ overnight; drought story unchanged
Corn	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Dec +5¼¢ overnight, extending the post-USDA upturn on mixed weather
Soybeans	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Nov +3¾¢; all eyes on tomorrow's export sales vs the MY-low baseline

Direction: -3 Very bearish → +3 Very bullish. Crowd: 0 two-sided → 3 crowded & uniform (contrarian risk). Sentiment reflects the tone of current news and trader coverage about the price outlook, not the last price move.

BIGGEST SHIFTS

Natural gas upgraded to Leaning bearish (-1) — its first upgrade since the July 6 downgrade, on two genuine changes: Iran attacked and damaged an **LNG tanker** in Hormuz (the first of the conflict), sending global gas prices higher and making the LNG-security tail flagged in prior editions real; and forecasts flipped back to **widespread late-July heat** across much of the US. Comfortable storage still caps it at -1, but the one-sided bear case is gone. That narrows the **crude–natgas spread to +1** from its +2 peak — the war-risk premium now lives in both energy legs, so the spread is no longer a clean escalation trade. Everything else is a holding pattern into the 2pm ET Fed minutes, with one nuance worth knowing: the minutes record a meeting held *before* the weak June payrolls, which blunts their power to re-hawk the market.

RV pair matrix

Sentiment spread = leg1 – leg2; positive favors leg1 outperformance.

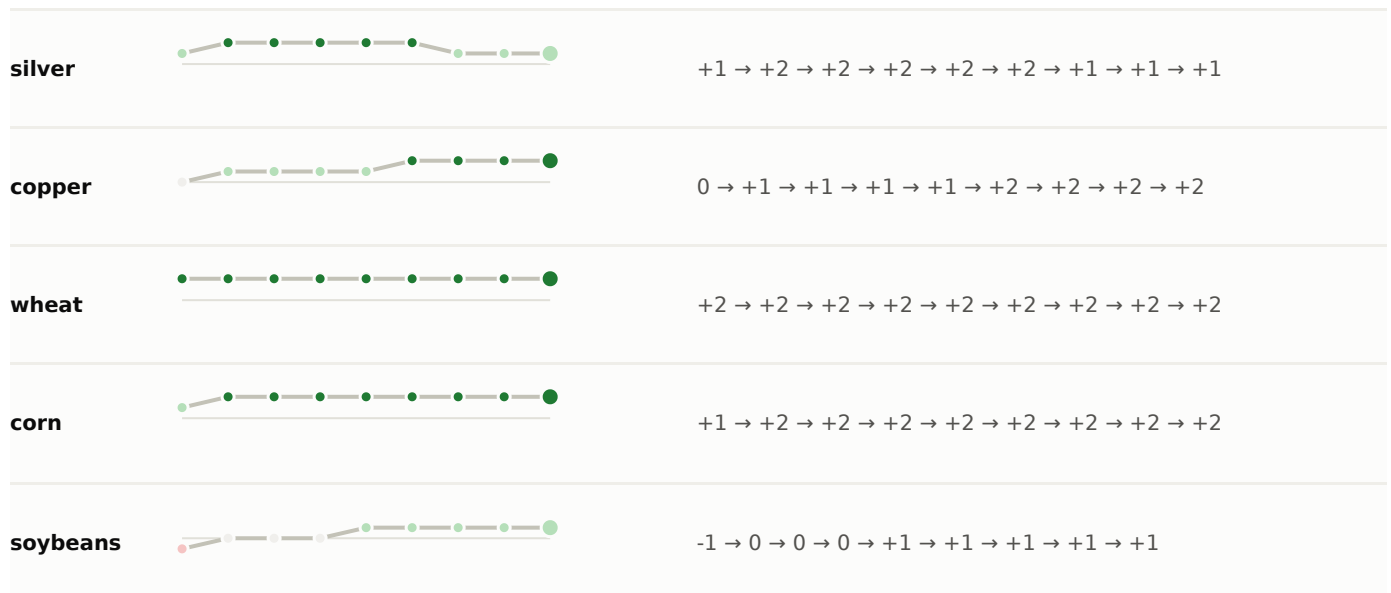
PAIR	SPREAD	Δ VS LAST	READ
gold – silver	0	unchanged	Same scores, but the price action diverges — silver under \$60.35 while gold holds \$4,141. If the minutes read dovish and silver still lags, that's a real ratio signal, not noise
corn – soybeans	+1	unchanged	Both firmer overnight; tomorrow's export sales print is the pair's decision point
corn – wheat	0	unchanged	Chicago outpaced KC overnight for the first time in days — watch whether the intra-wheat divergence is exhausting
crude – natgas	+1	▼ from +2	Narrowed. The LNG attack put war premium in the gas leg too; the spread expressed escalation well but is no longer the clean vehicle
gold – copper	-1	unchanged	Unchanged into the minutes; Friday's COT is copper's first positioning verdict

Catalyst calendar (next 7 days)

DATE	EVENT	LEGS	WHY IT MATTERS NOW
Wed Jul 8	FOMC minutes (2pm ET)	gold, silver, copper	Today. Pre-NFP meeting record — hawkish tone is partly stale by construction; dovish surprise hits harder
Wed Jul 8	EIA Weekly Petroleum Status (10:30am ET)	crude	Today. Confirms/denies API's reported large draws with a war premium already priced
Thu Jul 9	EIA natural gas storage (10:30am ET)	natural-gas	First print since the -1 upgrade; a lean injection extends the repair
Thu Jul 9	USDA weekly export sales (8:30am ET)	soybeans, corn, wheat	The beans decision: Cofco cargoes vs MY-low baseline
Thu Jul 9	US Drought Monitor update	wheat, corn	Plains footprint check
Fri Jul 10	CFTC COT + Saxo/Hansen note (3:30pm ET)	all	Wheat short-covering; copper's first post-deficit-story positioning read; crude spec response to attack week
Fri Jul 10	Kitco Weekly Gold Survey	gold	Post-minutes consensus check
Jul 10-12 window	USDA WASDE	wheat, corn, soybeans	First full balance sheet since the acreage shocks
Mon Jul 13	USDA Crop Progress (4pm ET)	corn, soybeans	Pollination conditions vs the late-July heat now in forecasts

Score history (oldest → newest)

crude-oil		-2 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → 0 → 0
natural-gas		-1 → -1 → -1 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -1
gold		+1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1



Crude Oil (WTI / Brent)

0 Neutral / mixed

●○○ 1

What's happening. WTI holds near \$70 (Brent ~\$74) after Tuesday's 3% attack-driven settlement, and the API reportedly showed very large crude and product draws overnight ([OilPrice](#) — exact week attribution unconfirmed in the snippet; today's EIA print is the arbiter). The bear stack (OPEC+ barrels arriving, Aramco's OSP cut) is unchanged beneath the war premium.

Social pulse. Retail oil gauges reheating on the escalation; discount the recirculated June-spike posts.

Positioning read. Unchanged 0: draws plus escalation versus scheduled supply. Today's EIA either validates the API draws (floor firms above \$70) or contradicts them (premium leaks). The read stays regime-dependent — headlines short-term, balances beyond.

Natural Gas

-1 Leaning bearish

○○○ 0

What's happening. *Upgraded.* Iran attacked and damaged an LNG tanker in Hormuz — the first of the conflict — sending global gas prices higher, while US forecasts flipped back to widespread late-July heat. August Nymex climbed, though comfortable storage (+6.2% vs average) and ~110 Bcf/d production kept the move range-bound ([NGI](#), [Investing.com](#)).

Social pulse. The crowd's long-standing bullish lean (55-60% in polls) is finally getting news-flow support — the divergence that defined this leg is closing from the news side.

Positioning read. The two catalysts that could flip this leg (heat and LNG security) both moved in the same week — that's why -2 was retired. Still -1 because storage math caps rallies until injections actually shrink. Tomorrow's EIA print is the test; TTF/JKM headlines are the accelerant. The crowd that was early is starting to be right — fading them here has stopped paying.

Gold

+1 Leaning bullish

●●○ 2

What's happening. Gold eased ~0.6% to \$4,141 (futures \$4,157) as oil-led inflation nerves and pre-minutes caution offset the safe-haven bid ([CNBC](#)). Key nuance: today's minutes record the June 16-17 meeting — *before* the weak June payrolls — so a hawkish tone is partly stale by construction; markets also read them for new Chair Warsh's leanings ([FXStreet](#)).

Social pulse. Unchanged: GLD light and positive on WSB.

Positioning read. The event risk is asymmetric in gold's favor: hawkish minutes are discountable as pre-NFP, while any dovish color validates the 50% repricing. With the Hormuz cushion underneath, gold's downside on today's event looks contained — the +1 with crowd 2 is comfortable.

Silver

+1 Leaning bullish

●●○ 2

What's happening. Silver slid a third session, dipping below \$60 before recovering to ~\$60.35 — now clearly underperforming gold ([FXStreet](#), [Trading Economics](#)).

Social pulse. WSB split unchanged (58/42); the crowd that bought the dips is underwater on the week.

Positioning read. The trim to +1 keeps proving right — silver has given back most of the jobs-report pop while gold held. The tell now: if the minutes read dovish and silver *still* lags gold, the ratio move is real (industrial-demand doubts, not just Fed positioning), and gold–silver at 0 starts to look generous to silver. Watch the post-minutes relative move, not the absolute one.

Copper +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Copper holds its narrow range around \$6.21 for a second week; nothing has challenged the structural stack (TC/RC \$0, concentrate stocks at historic lows, Yangshan premium firming) ([Trading Economics](#), [Investing.com](#)).

Social pulse. Quiet; still no retail crowd.

Positioning read. Unchanged. A flat price on an intact deficit story into Friday's COT — the first positioning print since the story broke — remains the board's cleanest setup. Fed-minutes risk shared with the precious legs but with the least crowd to unwind.

Wheat +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Overnight: Chicago +2¢, Minneapolis +2¢, KC -¾¢ — the first session in days where Chicago outpaced KC. The structural story (63% of winter wheat in drought, smallest crop since 1965/66) is unchanged ([Farm Progress](#), [Barchart](#)).

Social pulse. Unchanged mood/money split over the extreme short base.

Positioning read. One overnight session doesn't end the KC-over-Chicago run, but it's worth flagging ahead of Friday's COT: if the squeeze is starting, it typically shows in the most-shortest contract first. WASDE (Jul 10-12) is the balance-sheet risk both ways.

Corn +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. December corn +5¼¢ overnight, extending the post-USDA upturn as mixed weather outlooks (late-July heat vs eastern-belt rains) keep uncertainty in the price ([Farm Progress](#)).

Social pulse. Still lagging; no retail crowd.

Positioning read. The heat now back in late-July forecasts is corn's friend and extends the weather premium's shelf life past Monday's Crop Progress. Unchanged +2; the corn–soybean spread remains the fade vehicle if the rains verify instead.

Soybeans +1 Leaning bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. November beans +3¾¢ overnight, holding the China-bid gains into tomorrow's export sales print against the marketing-year-low baseline ([AgWeb](#), [Barchart](#)).

Social pulse. No fresh signal.

Positioning read. Unchanged and still near-binary on tomorrow 8:30am ET: cargoes printing opens +2, an empty week fades the rally. Also check USDA daily flash-sale announcements this morning — a ≥100kt China flash would front-run the weekly print.